

## AY25 PROGRAM ASSESSMENT REPORT

### Tracking data

|                                              |                                                                                                                                 |
|----------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| CIM code                                     | MDS-IDDG                                                                                                                        |
| Program name                                 | Master of Design (MDes)                                                                                                         |
| Assessment plan year                         | 2024/2025                                                                                                                       |
| Program assessment coordinator               | Matt Mayfield (mayfield@id.iit.edu)                                                                                             |
| Year of Current Assessment Plan              | 2024                                                                                                                            |
| No assessment this year <b>per plan</b>      | <input type="checkbox"/>                                                                                                        |
| LO(s) assessed                               | 3: Envision, demonstrate, and critically evaluate design proposals<br>5: Bring a “Systems Thinking” approach to design problems |
| Presented at program authority meeting date: | ID Faculty Meeting October 16, 2025                                                                                             |
|                                              |                                                                                                                                 |

### Methodology/ Evidence reviewed

This year’s assessment plan builds on the structure established in the previous cycle, focusing on two of the six Learning Objectives of the Master of Design (MDes) degree program. The objectives under review for this cycle are:

**3. *Envision, demonstrate, and critically evaluate design proposals.***

**5. *Apply a “Systems Thinking” approach to design problems.***

The evaluation centers on the analysis of final presentations from courses most directly aligned with these objectives. While many courses in the curriculum contribute to the development of these competencies, the assessment focuses on required courses to ensure both consistency and a comprehensive measure of student achievement, as outlined in the Fall 2024 assessment plan.

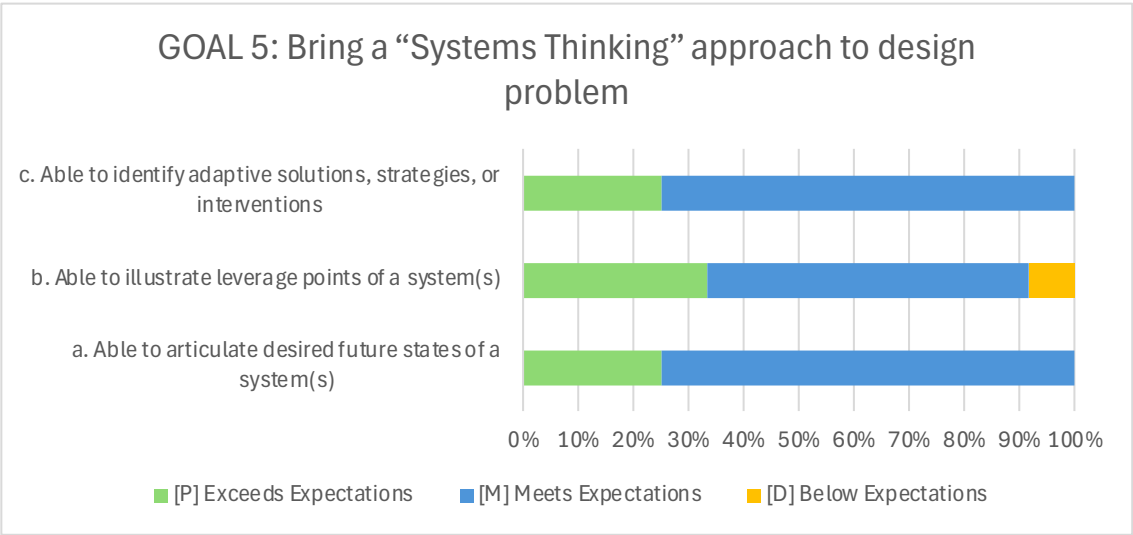
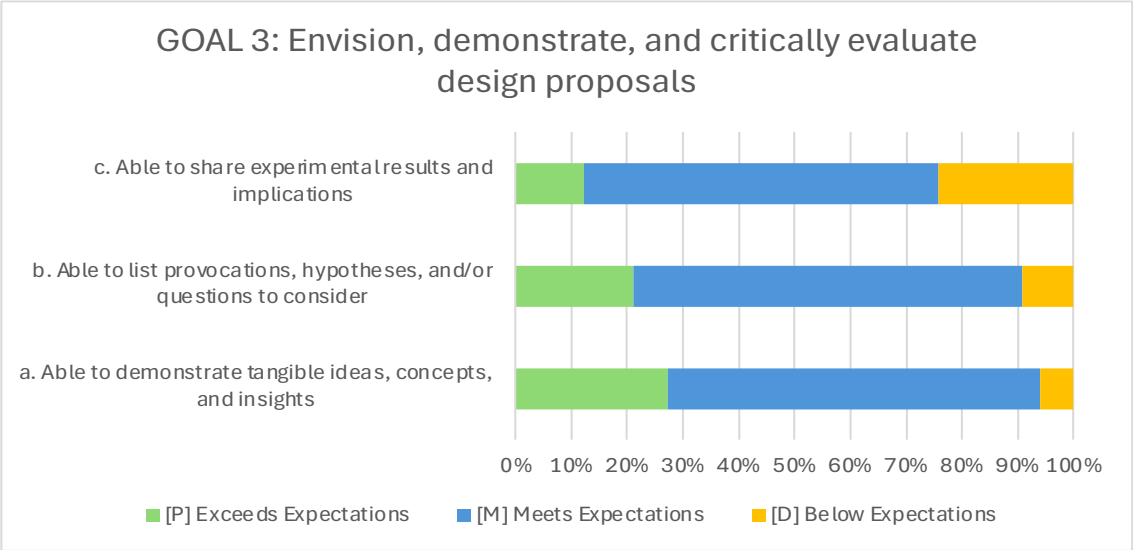
Although the program is relatively small and emphasizes team-based projects, the evidence gathered at the graduate level provides clear insight into both areas of strength and opportunities for refinement. The following table summarizes the collected evidence for each Learning Objective and its corresponding rubric-based evaluations.

| Learning Goal Assessed         | Goal 3: Envision, demonstrate, and critically evaluate design proposals                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
|--------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Assessment rubric              | <p>Outcomes to evaluate for each piece of evidence:</p> <ol style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Able to demonstrate tangible ideas, concepts, and insights</li> <li>Able to list provocations, hypotheses, and/or questions to consider</li> <li>Able to share experimental results and implications</li> </ol> | <p>Assessment Categories:</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li><b>[D] Below expectations:</b> No theories/methods from the course referenced or applied</li> <li><b>[M] Meeting expectations:</b> Theories/methods from the course applied, but with uneven or limited success</li> <li><b>[P] Exceeding expectations:</b> Comprehensive and appropriate application of theories/methods covered in the course</li> </ul> |
| Evidence/Artifact source(s)    | IDN 501, IDN 503 Final Presentations/Projects (33 pieces evaluated)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| Location of evidence/artifacts | <a href="#">Evidence</a> (Microsoft Teams)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |

| Learning Goal Assessed         | Goal 5: Bring a “Systems Thinking” approach to design problems                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
|--------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Assessment rubric              | <p>Outcomes to evaluate for each piece of evidence:</p> <ol style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Able to articulate desired future states of a system(s)</li> <li>Able to illustrate leverage points of a system(s)</li> <li>Able to identify adaptive solutions, strategies, or interventions</li> </ol> | <p>Assessment Categories:</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li><b>[D] Below expectations:</b> No theories/methods from the course referenced or applied</li> <li><b>[M] Meeting expectations:</b> Theories/methods from the course applied, but with uneven or limited success</li> <li><b>[P] Exceeding expectations:</b> Comprehensive and appropriate application of theories/methods covered in the course</li> </ul> |
| Evidence/Artifact source(s)    | IDN 571 Final presentations (12 pieces evaluated)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| Location of evidence/artifacts | <a href="#">Evidence</a> (Microsoft Teams)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |

Results

Summary of findings



## Description of findings

The program standard requires that at least eighty percent of reviewed student artifacts meet or exceed expectations.

For **Goal 3**, evidence from multiple course sections demonstrates generally strong alignment with program objectives. However, a recurring issue was observed: many presentations did not clearly articulate the outcomes or implications of their proposed design concepts. This weakness appears systemic rather than isolated, as it spans instructors and sections, suggesting that the structure of the projects or time constraints—rather than instructional differences—limit students' ability to engage in deeper reflection. Despite this, the consistency of theoretical application across courses confirms that students grasp and employ design methodologies appropriately, though they need more time and guidance to critically evaluate their proposals' broader consequences.

For **Goal 5**, the analysis indicates the cohort is performing at or above expectations. Although the sample size was modest, the evidence collected from final presentations shows that students can identify leverage points within complex systems, frame desired future states, and propose adaptive interventions. The coherence of these outcomes across all evaluated work reinforces confidence in both instructional alignment and the curriculum's capacity to foster systems-level thinking.

## Continuous Improvement, CI, plans

### Prior CI plan impact

☐ *no previous CI plans available*

The prior improvement plan focused on expanding course evaluations to include explicit questions tied to program-level learning goals in addition to course-specific outcomes. Implementation has been delayed twice due to university-level platform changes and leadership transitions, and there remains no firm schedule for the new evaluation system. Recognizing this constraint, we will redirect our efforts toward areas of direct control. Specifically, course blueprints will be enhanced to delineate with greater precision how each required course contributes to the overarching MDes learning objectives and how assessment criteria connect to those goals. This will strengthen alignment between course outcomes, program expectations, and evidence collection.

The MDes program's comprehensive review—initiated last year—remains in progress. Its purpose is to ensure that the curriculum continues to reflect the evolving standards of professional design education. The review's findings will inform revisions to both course design and assessment rubrics, to be published for implementation in **Fall 2026**.

### This cycle's CI plan

☐ *After consideration and presentation to the program authority, no CI plans are recommended*

For this cycle, the key priority is to complete the MDes program review and finalize updates to course blueprints so that targeted objectives and corresponding evaluation rubrics are explicitly documented and shared across the faculty.

## Assessment Process Recommendations

The collection and management of assessment evidence remain persistent challenges. The university's transition from Google to Microsoft platforms has disrupted the workflow for artifact storage and the adoption of Canvas for evidence management. This shift has made it more difficult to ensure consistent submission and retrieval of materials for evaluation.

To address the process gap, we will collaborate closely with faculty to adapt Canvas functionalities, creating clearer processes for identifying, tagging, and storing evidence at the point of assignment and submission. This procedural adjustment aims to make the collection process more reliable, reduce administrative friction, and ensure that future assessments are supported by complete and accessible data.

## Assessment Plan for Upcoming Cycle

For the next assessment cycle AY 2025/2026, we will review learning goals, per the current assessment plan listed here. This will complete a full review of the six learning objectives of the program.

- 2. Advocate for human and humanity-centric principles for a given design problem**
  - a. Able to present comprehensive considerations
  - b. Able to identify appropriate guiding principles
  - c. Able to share identified paradoxes & tradeoffs to consider
  
- 6. Lead multidisciplinary teamwork towards actionable outcomes**
  - a. Able to facilitate across different disciplines/ perspectives involved
  - b. Able to articulate decisions and appropriate actions